

# Yang Wang [jaŋ<sup>35</sup> waŋ<sup>35</sup>]

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## Employment

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2024 - **University of Utah**  
Assistant professor, Department of Linguistics

## Education

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2021 - 2024 **University of California, Los Angeles**  
Ph.D. in *Linguistics*  
*Dissertation:* [Studies in morphophonological copying: Analysis, experimentation, and modeling](#)  
*Committee:* Tim Hunter, Bruce Hayes (co-chairs), Claire Moore-Cantwell, Kie Zuraw, Colin Wilson (external)

2019 - 2021 **University of California, Los Angeles**  
M.A. in *Linguistics*  
*Thesis:* [Regular languages extended with reduplication: Formal models, proofs and illustrations](#)  
*Committee:* Tim Hunter (chair), Bruce Hayes, Dylan Bumford

2015 - 2019 **University of California, Los Angeles**  
BACHELOR OF ARTS AND SCIENCE *Cum Laude*  
Major in *Mathematics of computation*  
Major in *Linguistics*

## Publications

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(= indicates alphabetically-ordered authors.)

PEER REVIEWED JOURNAL ARTICLES & PROCEEDINGS

To appear **Wang, Yang** & Bruce Hayes. [Learning underlying representations: The role of abstractness](#). *Linguistic Inquiry*.

2023 **Wang, Yang** & Tim Hunter. [On regular copying languages](#). *Journal of Language Modelling*. 11(1): 1–66

2021 **Wang, Yang**. [Recognizing reduplicated forms: Finite-State Buffered Machines](#). In *Proceedings of the 18th SIGMORPHON Workshop on Computational Research in Phonetics, Phonology, and Morphology*, 177–187, Online. Association for Computational Linguistics.

## Presentations

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(\* indicates the presenter if multiple-authored; ‡ indicates equal contribution)

INVITED TALK

2026 **Wang, Yang** & Tim Hunter. *On regular copying languages*. Invited talk at the *online seminars on Formal Language Theory, Natural Language Processing, Machine Learning and Computational Linguistics (FLANN)*. TBA.

2026 **Wang, Yang**. *The emergent typology of reduplication: Experimental and computational evidence*. Colloquium. New York University. New York. February 6.

2025 **Wang, Yang**. *Learning biases reflect linguistic typology: The case of reduplication*. Invited talk at the Breiss Lab. University of Southern California. Los Angeles, CA. February 26.

- 2024 **Wang, Yang.** *Copying and how to learn it: Insights from computation and experimentation.* Colloquium. University of Utah. Salt Lake City, UT, February 6.
- 2024 **Wang, Yang.** *Copying and how to learn it: Insights from computation and experimentation.* Colloquium. University of Michigan. Ann Arbor, MI. January 23.
- 2024 **Wang, Yang.** *What does formal language theory tell us about the nature of reduplication?* Invited talk presented at the session on Formal Language Theory in Morphology and Phonology. The 97th Annual Meeting of the Linguistic Society of America, New York, NY. January 4-7.
- 2023 Hayes, Bruce\* & **Yang Wang\***. *Learning underlying representations in phonology: The role of abstractness.* Colloquium. Stony Brook University. New York, NY. April 14.

#### CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

- 2024 **Wang, Yang.** *The emergent typology of reduplication: Universals and variations in learning biases.* Poster presented at the Annual Meeting on Phonology. Rutgers University, New Brunswick. November 1-3, 2024.
- 2022 Wilson, Colin & **Yang Wang\***. *Inductive bias in learning partial reduplication: Evidence from artificial grammar learning.* Talk presented at the Annual Meeting on Phonology. UCLA, Los Angeles, CA. October 21-23.
- 2022 **Wang, Yang\*** & Bruce Hayes\*. *Learning underlying representations: Expectation-maximization and the KK-Hierarchy.* Poster presented at the Annual Meeting on Phonology. UCLA, Los Angeles, CA. October 21-23.
- 2021 **Wang, Yang.** *A formal model for recognizing reduplication.* Poster presented at the Annual Meeting on Phonology. Online, hosted by the University of Toronto and York University. October 1-3.
- 2021 **Wang, Yang.** *Adding reduplication to finite-state machinery.* Talk presented at the 32nd ESSLI Student Session. Online. August 6.
- 2021 **Wang, Yang.** *Recognizing Reduplicated Forms: Finite-State Buffered Machines.* Talk presented at the 18th SIG-MORPHON. Online. August 5.

## Fellowships, Honors & Awards

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- 2023-2024 Dissertation Year Fellowship (\$20,000), UCLA Graduate Division
- 2022 Summer Graduate Summer Research Mentorship (\$6,000), UCLA Graduate Division (Supervisor: Tim Hunter)
- 2020-2021 Edward L. Keenan Mathematics & Language Graduate Fellowship (\$3950)
- 2019 Graduate Dean's Scholar Award (\$14,500) *with two years of summer funding*
- 2019 - 2020 Friends of Linguistics Scholarship (\$15,000), UCLA Linguistics department
- 2019 Departmental Honors, UCLA Linguistics department
- 2019 Phi Beta Kappa, UCLA

## Teaching

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#### INDEPENDENT STUDIES

- Fall 2025 **Probabilistic learning of linguistic structures.** Jade Ramirez-Barraza. (University of Utah, undergraduate)

#### AS AN INSTRUCTOR

- Ling 2300 **Computers & AI** (University of Utah, undergraduate)  
2026 Fall (planned)
- Ling 3010 **Intro Phonetics & Phonology** (University of Utah, undergraduate)  
2026 Spring, 2026 Fall (planned)
- Ling 4011 **Intermediate Phonetics & Phonology** (University of Utah, undergraduate)  
2026 Spring
- Ling 6011 **Formal Phonology** (University of Utah, graduate)  
2025 Fall

Ling 6080 **Topics in Computational linguistics**(University of Utah, graduate)  
2025 Fall: [Models of morphological and phonological learning](#)

Ling 3340 **Introduction to Computational Linguistics** (University of Utah; undergraduate)  
2025 Spring

Ling 2200 **Introduction to the study of languages** (University of Utah; undergraduate)  
2024 Fall

Ling 185A **Computational Linguistics I** (UCLA; undergraduate)  
2023 Summer

AS A TEACHING ASSISTANT (UCLA)

Ling 20 **Introduction to Linguistic Analysis**  
2020 Fall (Instructor: Tim Hunter); 2022 Fall (Instructor: Ben Eischens)

Ling 185A **Computational Linguistics I**  
2022 Winter (Instructor: Dylan Bumford); 2021 Winter (Instructor: Tim Hunter)

Ling 185B **Computational Linguistics II**  
2023 Spring, 2022 Spring, 2021 Spring (Instructor: Tim Hunter)

Ling 119A **Applied Phonology**  
2024 Spring (Instructor: Sam Zukoff)

GUEST LECTURER

2024 Fall Computational learning models in linguistics (University of Utah; Instructor: Caleb Belth)  
*Lecture:* Maximum Entropy and the “Inductive Baseline” approach to abstract structure

2021 Winter Computational Linguistics I (UCLA; Instructor: Tim Hunter)  
*Lecture:* Sub-regular phonology and the puzzle of reduplication

## Advising and mentorship

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CHAIR

ongoing June Howard, MA

COMMITTEE MEMBER

ongoing Chalee Yates, PhD  
ongoing Olalekan Adebayo, PhD  
ongoing John Paulson, PhD

UNDERGRADUATE MENTORING

2025 Fall - Sara Fong (Linguistics, post-bac)  
Project: *Experimental investigations of the interaction between phonological processing and cognitive constraints.*

2025 Fall - Jade Ramirez-Barraza (Linguistics/Economics).  
Project: *Learning syntactic non-local dependencies.*  
Undergraduate research opportunities program recipient for Fall 2025.

## Research Experience

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2022 Winter Research assistant, Supervisor: Dr. Tim Hunter, UCLA Department of Linguistics

2021 Fall Research assistant, Supervisor: Dr. Bruce Hayes, UCLA Department of Linguistics

2022 Summer

## UNDERGRADUATE EXPERIENCE

|                          |                                                                                                      |                                             |
|--------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------|
| 2017-2019                | <b>Sound Categorization &amp; Prosody</b><br>Principal Investigator: Dr. Jeremy Steffman             | Research Assistant<br>UCLA Phonetics Lab    |
| 2018-2019                | <b>Variance and Invariance in Voice Quality</b><br>Principal Investigator: Dr. Patricia Keating      | Research Assistant<br>UCLA Phonetics Lab    |
| June 2018 -<br>Aug. 2018 | <b>Activities Classification in LAPD Body Worn Videos</b><br>Project Lead: Dr. Matthew Haberland     | Research Assistant<br>UCLA Applied Math REU |
| June 2016 -<br>Sep. 2016 | <b>China Education Panel Survey</b><br>National Survey Research Center at Renmin University of China | Research Assistant                          |

## Service

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### UNIVERSITY OF UTAH

|       |                                                        |
|-------|--------------------------------------------------------|
| 2024- | <b>Member</b> , Colloquium Committee                   |
| 2024- | <b>Member</b> , Undergraduate Committee in Linguistics |

### UCLA

|              |                                                      |
|--------------|------------------------------------------------------|
| 2024/01 - 06 | <b>Co-Organizer</b> , Graduate student writing group |
| 2022 - 2023  | <b>Chair</b> , Colloquium Committee                  |
| 2021 - 2023  | <b>Member</b> , Colloquium Committee                 |

### PROFESSIONAL SERVICE

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|--------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <i>Grants</i>      | Ad hoc reviewer for National Science Foundation (Linguistics Program)                                                                               |
| <i>Journals</i>    | Phonology, Journal of East Asian Linguistics                                                                                                        |
| <i>Conferences</i> | Annual Meeting on Phonology (AMP), Mathematics of Language (MoL), the Annual Conference of the Society for Human Sentence Processing (HSP), LabPhon |

### OTHER SERVICE TO THE FIELD

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|------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 2025 | <b>Program Chair</b> , The 18th Meeting on the Mathematics of Language (MoL) |
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### OTHER EMPLOYMENT

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|-------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 2020 - 2021 | <b>Rater</b> , UCLA Test of Oral Proficiency for international Teaching Assistants |
| 2017 - 2019 | <b>Undergraduate homework grader</b> , UCLA Mathematics Department                 |

## Skills

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|------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Languages</b> | <b>Native:</b> Mandarin Chinese<br><b>Fluent:</b> English<br><b>Basic:</b> Russian<br><b>Fieldwork:</b> Cantel K'iche' |
| <b>Technical</b> | Python, Haskell, R, MATLAB, C++ , $\LaTeX$ , git                                                                       |

#### NON-DEGREE TRAINING

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|------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 2023 | <i>Summer School on Statistical Methods for Linguistics and Psychology</i> ; Advanced Bayesian statistics with Stan<br>University of Potsdam |
| 2023 | <i>LSA Summer Institute</i> ; University of Massachusetts Amherst                                                                            |
| 2021 | <i>European Summer School in Logic, Language and Information</i> ; Held virtually                                                            |
| 2019 | <i>European Summer School in Logic, Language and Information</i> ; University of Latvia                                                      |
| 2019 | <i>LSA Summer Institute</i> ; University of California, Davis                                                                                |